people of Tibet'. He added that Tibetan developments had to be seen in the context of 'the wider point of view of the peace of Asia and the world'.[60]

The Chinese view was that India was intimately connected with the origins and continuation of the Tibet rebellion. At a meeting of the CPC in Shanghai on 25 March, Mao pointed to India's role.[61] Under his direction, the Chinese press launched a vitriolic attack on Nehru and India. Garver, in his account of Chinese decision-making, notes that the press was ordered to describe India as expansionist and to criticize the Indian prime minister by name: Nehru had slandered China's actions in Tibet, identified with upper-class Tibetan reactionaries, and exemplified the Indian big bourgeoisie's expansionism which sought to reduce Tibet to a 'buffer zone'. Talking to a group of socialist representatives from various parts of the world, Zhou repeated the message and added that India's Tibet ambitions were 'the centre of the Sino-Indian conflict'.[62] In Mao's conversation with Soviet leader Nikita Khrushchev in October 1959, he said, 'The Hindus [sic] acted in Tibet as if it belonged to them.' Also in 1959, General Lei Yingfu of the PLA presented an analysis of Indian policy to Mao. He argued that India had worked with the Dalai Lama to try to split Tibet from China. Mao agreed. Years later, Mao told Nepalese visitors that the Indian government thought 'Tibet is theirs'.[63]

Apart from accusing bourgeois India of instigating the revolt, China had a long list of complaints about Delhi's behaviour. These included having the Indian consul general in Tibet meet Tibetan protesters; granting the Dalai Lama and his followers asylum; interacting officially with the Dalai Lama and accepting his references to a Tibet government-in-exile; settling the Tibetan refugees near the Chinese border and allowing political activities by them; restricting trade with Tibet; allowing and/or encouraging the Indian press and protesters to criticize China; and permitting parliamentary speeches and discussions of Tibet. In Beijing's view, Delhi's actions violated the 1954 Panchsheel agreement on peaceful coexistence which India and China had signed in October 1954 during Nehru's trip to Beijing. The five principles were mutual respect for each other's territorial integrity and sovereignty; mutual non-aggression; mutual non-interference; equality